

Hellenistic lots

As early as the beginnings of natal astrology, astrologers used lots. These points correspond to the distance between two planets, measured from the ascendant.

The basic idea

You determine the difference in longitude between two planets and add that difference to the longitude of the ascendant.

For the Pars Fortunae or Lot of Fortune, the best known of the lots, the formula is:

$$\text{Longitude ascendant} + \text{longitude Moon} - \text{longitude Sun}$$

Sect

The formula above applies to day charts, when the Sun is above the horizon. For night charts you use an adjusted formula; for the Lot of Fortune this becomes:

$$\text{Longitude ascendant} + \text{longitude Sun} - \text{longitude Moon}$$

So you reverse the roles of the Sun and the Moon.

Not all astrologers use sect, especially if they use only the Lot of Fortune among the lots. If you do want to use all the Hellenistic lots, it is wise to apply sect, also because otherwise it is hard to distinguish between the Lot of Fortune and the Lot of Spirit.

The seven lots

We use the seven original lots as described by Paulus of Alexandria. More lots have been added, by Hellenistic astrologers but especially by later Arabic astrologers. That is also the reason the lots are often referred to as *Arabic parts*. There are hundreds of these points. Here we limit ourselves to the seven original points.

The table shows the lots and the formulas.

LOT	DAY CALCULATION	NIGHT CALCULATION
Fortune	Asc. + Moon - Sun	Asc. + Sun - Moon
Spirit	Asc. + Sun - Moon	Asc. + Moon - Sun
Eros	Ascendant + Venus - Lot of Spirit	Asc. + Lot of Spirit - Venus
Victory	Asc. + Jupiter - Lot of Spirit	Asc. + Lot of Spirit - Jupiter
Necessity	Ascendant + Lot of Fortune - Mercury	Ascendant + Mercury - Lot of Fortune
Courage	Asc. + Lot of Fortune - Mars	Asc. + Mars - Lot of Fortune
Nemesis	Asc. + Lot of Fortune - Saturn	Asc. + Saturn - Lot of Fortune



- Alexandrinus, Paulus. *Introductory Matters*, trans. R. H. Schmidt, ed. R. S. Hand. Hindsight project, 1993.
- Brennan, Chris, *Hellenistic Astrology. The Study of Fate and Fortune*. 2017, Denver, Colorado. 511-534.